

T10 — Letter of Authorisation

Authority record. This letter records target-specific consent and the operational authority represented by its signatories. It is necessary but may not be sufficient: applicable law, regulation, contract, third-party rights and provider conditions remain in force. The legal adviser shall confirm the required authorisation chain for the actual jurisdiction, entities, systems and activities. This letter shall be:

- Signed by the person with **actual system authority** for every system or facility in scope, with operational risk countersigned where that authority is held separately.
- Short enough to be read and understood in under a minute by a police officer, a security guard, or a systems administrator.
- Comprehensible without reference to the Rules of Engagement. It stands alone.
- Carried by every operator, physically and digitally, for the whole engagement.

Verify each signatory's authority. A person without the relevant authority cannot confer valid system consent or risk acceptance. If systems belong to another legal entity, division, agency or third party, obtain that authority directly and record it in the ROE. Do not infer authority from title alone.

[ORGANISATION LETTERHEAD]

LETTER OF AUTHORISATION

Authorised Security Testing

Reference: [RT-YYYY-NNN] **Date of issue:** [DATE]

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

I, [FULL NAME], [TITLE] of [ORGANISATION], confirm that I hold the authority to authorise security testing of the information systems and facilities identified below, and that I hereby grant that authorisation.

1. Authorised personnel

The following individuals are authorised to conduct this testing:

Name	Role	Organisation	Identification
	Red Team Lead		
	Operator		
	Operator		

2. Authorised activity

The individuals named above are authorised to conduct security testing, which may include attempting to gain unauthorised access to, and to move within, the systems identified in paragraph 3, using techniques comparable to those used by malicious actors. This may include attempts to bypass technical controls and to obtain credentials.

Detailed limits and prohibitions are set out in the Rules of Engagement reference [RT-YYYY-NNN], which forms part of this authorisation.

3. Scope of authorisation

Item	Detail
Systems, networks and domains	
Owning legal entity or entities	
Provider / third-party permission references	
Physical locations (<i>if applicable</i>)	
Social engineering authorised	☐ Yes ☐ No
Physical access attempts authorised	☐ Yes ☐ No

Activity outside this scope is **not** authorised.

4. Period of authorisation

This authorisation is valid **from** [DATE] 00:00 UTC to [DATE] 23:59 UTC inclusive, and at no other time. It may be revoked at any time by me or by the Trusted Agent named below.

5. Verification

Any person wishing to verify this authorisation should contact:

Role	Name	Telephone (24 hours)
System Authority		
Approving Authority		
Trusted Agent		

These numbers are answered 24 hours a day for the duration of the period stated above.

6. Instructions to staff encountering this activity

Staff who encounter the individuals named above, or who detect activity they believe may be related to this testing, should:

- **Continue to follow normal security procedures**, including reporting and escalation. The testing is intended to measure those procedures.
- Contact the Trusted Agent named above if verification is required.
- **Not** discuss this authorisation more widely, as doing so may invalidate the testing.

7. Organisational authority and responsibility

The activity described above is conducted at the request of and with the authorisation of [ORGANISATION]. The individuals named in paragraph 1 are authorised only while acting within the scope, activity and period stated and in accordance with the Rules of Engagement. This paragraph does not create an indemnity, waive third-party rights, or replace any allocation of liability required by law or contract.

Legal / authority review reference: [REFERENCE]

Reviewed by: [NAME AND APPOINTMENT] Date: [DATE]

Signed by the System Authority

Signature	
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Name	[FULL NAME]
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Title	[TITLE]
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Organisation	[ORGANISATION]
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Date	
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Countersigned by the Approving Authority, where different

Signature	
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Name	[FULL NAME]
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Title	[TITLE]
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Organisation	[ORGANISATION]
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Date	
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Immediate-Verification Card

Separate from the Letter of Authorisation. Carried by each operator, particularly for physical or on-site work.

Contains nothing but the following. No scope, no techniques, no target list, no ROE extract. Its only purpose is de-escalation and rapid verification by someone who has just detained the operator. Any additional detail is intelligence handed to whoever is holding it.

Verification detail	Information
Status	AUTHORISED SECURITY TESTING IN PROGRESS
Bearer	The bearer is conducting authorised security testing on behalf of [ORGANISATION].
Engagement reference	[RT-YYYY-NNN]
Approving Authority	[APPROVING AUTHORITY NAME]
Telephone, 24 hours	[TELEPHONE]
Trusted Agent	[TRUSTED AGENT NAME]
Telephone, 24 hours	[TELEPHONE]
Immediate action	Call to verify before taking further action.

Operator instructions if challenged

1. **Stop immediately.** Do not resist, evade, or leave.
2. State clearly: *“I am conducting authorised security testing for [ORGANISATION].”*
3. Produce the verification card. Ask that the number be called.
4. Comply with all instructions given by security personnel or law enforcement.
5. Do not disclose scope, techniques, targets, or the ROE.
6. Contact the Red Team Lead and Trusted Agent as soon as permitted.
7. Record what happened as soon as possible afterwards.

Where physical entry is authorised, the Trusted Agent shall confirm before execution that site security leadership and, where appropriate, local law enforcement liaison have been briefed that authorised activity is occurring in the period — without disclosing timing or method.

Confirmed by Trusted Agent on: _____